

Elder Abuse Prevention & Long-Term Care Advocacy

Learner guide | SWP-012 | School of Gerontology & Aging Services

This guide supports a three-part learning sequence for Elder Abuse Prevention & Long-Term Care Advocacy. By the end of the course, you should be able to recognise elder abuse and advocate for safety, rights, and quality care.

Practice notice: Apply the law, organisational policy, supervision requirements, and approved referral pathways that govern your setting. This material supports learning and does not replace urgent safeguarding, clinical, or legal procedures.

Learning objectives

- Recognise elder abuse and advocate for safety, rights, and quality care.
- Apply the key ideas from Forms and indicators of abuse.
- Apply the key ideas from Safe response.
- Apply the key ideas from Advocacy in long-term care.

Course structure

Module	Focus	Suggested study time
1. Forms and indicators of abuse	physical, emotional, sexual, financial, neglect, and institutional harm	10 to 15 minutes
2. Safe response	private inquiry, capacity/consent considerations, documentation, reporting, and emergency action	10 to 15 minutes
3. Advocacy in long-term care	rights, complaints, quality monitoring, family involvement, and systems improvement	10 to 15 minutes

Module 1 Forms and indicators of abuse

This module focuses on physical, emotional, sexual, financial, neglect, and institutional harm. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Physical
- Emotional
- Sexual
- Financial
- Neglect
- Institutional harm

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of forms and indicators of abuse in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of physical, emotional, sexual, financial, neglect, and institutional harm. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through forms and indicators of abuse safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 2 Safe response

This module focuses on private inquiry, capacity/consent considerations, documentation, reporting, and emergency action. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Private inquiry
- Capacity/consent considerations
- Documentation
- Reporting
- Emergency action

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of safe response in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of private inquiry, capacity/consent considerations, documentation, reporting, and emergency action. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through safe response safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 3 Advocacy in long-term care

This module focuses on rights, complaints, quality monitoring, family involvement, and systems improvement. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Rights
- Complaints
- Quality monitoring
- Family involvement
- Systems improvement

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of advocacy in long-term care in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of rights, complaints, quality monitoring, family involvement, and systems improvement. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through advocacy in long-term care safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Course activity

Use the accompanying worksheet to apply the course sequence to a short case. Your completed activity should show what you noticed, the action you would take within your role, and what you would escalate or verify locally.

Assessment preparation

- Review the distinction between: indicators.
- Review the distinction between: safe response.
- Review the distinction between: reporting.
- Review the distinction between: resident rights.

References and local adaptation

- SWEEP Academy Course Content Outlines, production blueprint for this course.
- The current legislation, professional standards, safeguarding procedures, and referral directories for the delivery jurisdiction.
- The learner's employer or placement policy, supervision arrangements, and documentation standards.